

PURPOSE: To adequately distribute privilege plans within the 1-2 week timeframe as defined in the student handbook.

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BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE SENATE:

SECTION ONE (REASONING):

On page 111 of the student handbook (or page 116 in the PDF version), it is explicitly stated that "Evaluations and distribution of privilege plans will be completed 1-2 weeks after the finalization of the most recent academic quarter (nine-weeks)." However, it is imperative to note that this stipulated timeline has not been adhered to since its introduction in November of 2022.

Being a student at MSMS is a challenging endeavor, and it is anticipated that the residential life staff appropriately bestow earned privilege plans upon the student body. Unfortunately, it has become a common occurrence that these privilege plans are distributed only a few weeks before the academic quarter's conclusion. This timing leaves students with plans that are either outdated or, in some cases, entirely absent.

A notable issue pertains to the Junior Plan, which is originally designed for the first nine weeks of the academic year. Regrettably, juniors, both presently and historically, have found themselves compelled to adhere to this plan for an extended duration, thereby restricting their ability to leave campus by car or enjoy respite from the rigors of their study hours.

Similarly, seniors often contend with the use of severely outdated privilege plans throughout a significant portion of the first semester. This is primarily because they are not promptly provided with new privilege plans upon their return from the summer break. This delay is particularly frustrating, given that the transition to senior status is expected to grant students access to more expansive and desirable privilege plans.

SECTION TWO (RESPONSES):

Response 1 (Anonymous-Senior):

Last year, I, along with the other juniors, were on Junior Plan for an extended period. This was, for lack of a better word, annoying because I was on heavy restrictions when I knew I had earned more freedom. It occurred throughout the rest of the year as well which was frustrating when I knew I had moved up a plan.

Response 2 (Anonymous-Senior):

Seniors this year didn't get a plan for their fourth nine weeks of junior year for the whole first nine weeks of senior year which caused a lot of problems. Especially if they were on IP plan or Junior Plan their 3rd nine weeks of junior year which is completely unfair for the students who have worked so hard.

Response 3 (Anonymous-Senior):

I can understand some delay on the privilege plans; however, I have the same card from my junior year, and we are now in November of my senior year. I feel it is really confusing when I should have certain privileges, but I don't because nothing has been updated. It's also just frustrating.

Response 4 (Anonymous-Junior):

I think this is a great idea, I support this because we, as students, are put at an immediate deadline why should we not have some of that reciprocated? And even if not a deadline just something in the handbook regarding the long wait time with an explanation would really help students.

Response 5 (Anonymous-Junior):

I think that it's frustrating that we aren't able to find out what privilege plan we are on until 3-4 weeks after the first 9 weeks. If students aren't allowed to use their privileges that they work for during the first 9 weeks, it may discourage students who see privilege plans as a reward.

Response 6 (Anonymous-Junior):

I think that the staff this year have not been upholding a lot of things that they should be and it's kind of ridiculous that it's already been almost half of the second quarter and juniors still haven't gotten our privilege plans yet.

SECTION THREE (PROPOSED ACTION):

To distribute privilege plans within the time frame defined in the student handbook, rather than the residential life staff's convenience.